



Issue #23 - February 2022

BERNERA NEWS

A Community Newsletter **The Daily Ceilidh**
in association with

Welcome to Issue 23 of the Bernera News.

This week there was a stark reminder of the power of nature, when lightning struck a house in Uig. The family were incredibly lucky to escape unharmed, but the effect of such an event will no doubt be with them for a long time.

It was therefore heartening to hear that, as ever, the local communities have already responded with help and offers. From the fire crews that attended on the night, putting themselves at risk in such challenging circumstances, through to those within the community who have offered everything from clothing to accommodation.

Yet again, we hear this word "community". According to the Cambridge Dictionary it usually refers to "the people living in one particular area" or "people who are considered a unit because of their common interests, social group, or nationality". But in reality it is more than that. It is about the willingness to pull together to ensure that all within are safe and looked after.

What constitutes a community is not just about where we live, or about our nationalities or interests; it's about this unselfish act of inclusion and caring for those around us, whatever the circumstances.

Our thoughts go out to the Scott's from Ardrol, Uig, who lost their home in such shocking circumstances this week. It is believed that lightning struck their chimney, causing significant damage, as well as a fire to start within the property. Thankfully the couple were able to escape, complete with their dogs, but the fire quickly took hold and the house was destroyed, despite the very best efforts by the fire crews in attendance. Crews from Uig, Bernera, Shawbost and Stornoway attended, working in atrocious conditions. It is perhaps a timely reminder of the incredible work of our retained crews, and their dedication to keeping us all as safe as possible in such circumstances. Our thanks go to each and every one of the crews. Your commitment and hard work are so very much appreciated by the communities that you serve.

It is also perhaps an appropriate time to ask if there are others within our communities who may consider joining the Scottish Fire and Rescue Service as a Retained Firefighter. An annual retainer fee is paid, plus additional payments for every incident attended, as well as time spent on all activities in an official capacity, for example training nights and courses. For more information speak to any of our local firemen or email: sfrs.retainedrecruitment@firescotland.gov.uk

COVID UPDATE

Despite the possibility of restrictions easing in the next few months, covid cases locally have been on the rise. NHS Western Isles report that over 250 people have tested positive in the Western Isles in the past 10 days (as of 24th Feb). Thankfully, hospital admission rates remain low, and in most cases only mild or no symptoms appear to be the norm. However, for some people catching covid can still cause a significant health risk. They therefore ask that people continue to take simple, yet important steps to reduce the effect on our communities. Everyone is asked to continue to self isolate and book PCR tests if you have symptoms. Lateral Flow Device testing should only be used by those without symptoms, and ideally before mixing with other people, especially in large groups. Hand hygiene remains of vital importance, and whilst the use of face coverings remains in place at this time, it is also recommended to continue with this once restrictions end, particularly in indoor public places, and on public transport.

LESS SURVIVABLE CANCERS AWARENESS

Following on from our article last month on Less Survivable Cancers, this month we will look at Pancreatic Cancer.

60% of people with pancreatic cancer are not diagnosed until the cancer is at an advanced stage. This is partly due to the fact that it often doesn't cause symptoms in the early stages. In addition, symptoms may come and go, especially to begin with, or not be specific to pancreatic cancer, which makes it more difficult to diagnose.

Pancreatic cancer affects men and women in the same way, although symptoms can vary for each person. Not everyone will have all of the symptoms listed here. It is also important to remember that these symptoms can be caused by lots of things, and are unlikely to be pancreatic cancer.

The most common symptoms are:

Tummy pain or back pain. The pain may start as general discomfort or tenderness in the tummy area and spread to the back. It can be worse when lying down, and sitting forward can sometimes make it feel better. It may be worse after eating.

Indigestion

Weight loss

Other symptoms you may get include:

Losing your appetite. Changes to your bowel habits. Jaundice (yellow skin or eyes and itchy skin) Recently diagnosed diabetes. Problems digesting food, such as feeling full quickly when you eat, bloating, burping or wind. Feeling or being sick. Blood clots. Feeling very tired (fatigue)

If you have jaundice you should go immediately to your GP or the A&E department at the nearest hospital. If you have any of the other symptoms, you don't know why you have them, and they last four weeks or more, make an appointment to see your GP. Be sure to tell them all of your symptoms, no matter how vague, and mention anything unusual, even if you're not sure it is relevant.

For more information visit www.pancreaticcancer.org.uk

NATIONAL ADULT PROTECTION DAY

National Adult Support and Protection Day 2022 took place on 20th February. NHS Western Isles supports this important awareness raising day which is an annual reminder to act on any concerns about vulnerable adults who you suspect may be at risk from harm, neglect or exploitation.

An adult may be at risk of harm if they are over 16 years, unable to safeguard their own wellbeing, property, rights and other interests, are at risk of harm (to themselves and others) and are affected by illness, mental disorder, disability or physical or mental infirmity.

Most people can think of someone they know who they worry about sometimes, a friend, family member or neighbour. In general, physical harm and financial harm are the most common forms of harm perpetrated against adults at risk, but adult protection covers a wide range of harm. This includes everything from sexual harm to psychological harm; self-harm to neglect or self-neglect – when people struggle to take care of themselves.

Making a Referral

Our message is simple – if you think an adult is at risk of harm and something feels wrong, you're right to get it checked out. If you see something, say something. All it takes is a single e-mail or phone call, even an anonymous call to allow sensitive enquiries.

dorothy.macdonald2@nhs.scot Tel : 01851 708029

DOG ATTACKS ON LIVESTOCK

Most of us are aware of the risk to livestock when dog owners fail to act responsibly. However, some people continue to pay scant regard to the laws and regulations governing such behaviour. With recent changes to legislation, including much tougher punishments, it is hoped that more people will realise the seriousness of such behaviour, and ensure their dogs are under proper control at all times.

According to the new legislation an offence takes place where a dog attacks or worries livestock on agricultural land. This includes croft and common grazing lands. With a maximum penalty of 12 months imprisonment, or a fine of up to £40,000, there is even more of an incentive to ensure our dogs are not able to worry or attack livestock.

A new campaign, Your Dog - Your Responsibility, has recently been endorsed by the NFU in an attempt to promote a clearer understanding of the responsibilities of dog owners.

The simplest way of being a responsible dog owner is to always keep your dog in sight and under control. If your dog is unlikely to respond to commands, or you are not sure, always use a lead. And remember, a dog chasing livestock is not funny, and could even land you with a prison sentence.

ANNA MACKINNON

Many people in our community will know Anna MacKinnon, some from when she taught at the school, others from her more recent community work, or perhaps through her involvement in the church. It is therefore perhaps unsurprising, but so very well deserved, that Anna has recently become the first person on the Isle of Lewis to receive an award from the Scarr-Hall Memorial Fund in recognition for her lifetime of dedicated service to her local communities.

Although now retired, Anna continues to be actively involved in so many local organisations. From being an integral part of the Uig News, right through to teaching Gaelic classes over Zoom throughout lockdowns, Anna's commitment, perseverance, and hard work seem to never cease.

Unbeknown to most, Anna also supports us here at the Bernera News, as she kindly proofreads and edits our gaelic pieces each month.

We would therefore like to congratulate her on such a well deserved award, and to thank her for all that she does for our community both here in Bernera, and in the wider area.

BERNERA COMMUNITY ASSOCIATION



We would like to welcome Caren MacLennan to the post of Administrator for the Bernera Community Association. She will be employed for a 12 month period, start date 21st February and is based between the Community Centre and home.

Her focus will be to implement recovery from the impact covid has had on the centre and the surrounding community of Bernera and Tir Mor and to oversee the day to day running of the centre, identifying ways to support and engage all members of the community through activities.

GREAT BERNERA COMMUNITY DEVELOPMENT TRUST

Great Bernera Community Development Trust
Part-time Community Development Officer (Number of hours by negotiation)
Salary: £24000 Pro rata. Fixed Term: 31st March 2023

Great Bernera Community Development Trust is looking for an outgoing and self-motivated individual to support our work as we complete the installation of pontoons at Kirkibost and seek to attract funding for other projects including restaurant facilities, affordable housing and other developments to create employment and additional facilities in our community.

The key role of the Development Officer is to underpin the work of the Board and GBCDT volunteers in taking control of the project themselves, they will therefore largely have a supporting, enabling and administrative role.

Principal areas of work include supporting the Board to inform, involve and engage the community, assisting the Board in completing the pontoon project and undertaking discrete pieces of market research work for additional income generation. They will also assist the Board with administrative tasks such as organising meetings and events, booking venues and taking minutes.

Applicants must have excellent communication skills, a good track record of completing funding applications and managing claims, a keen interest in the work of land trusts and a willingness to work outside normal office hours as required. The ability to work unsupervised is essential. Remote working may be considered.

Employment will be for a 12-month period ending no later than 31st March 2023 in the first instance. An extension is dependent on on-going grant funding as a result of actions taken by the Board and post holder.

This post is funded by The Scottish Government through Highlands and Islands Enterprise.

For further information, discussion and an application pack please contact Anne Ryan, Chair, Great Bernera Community Development Trust. trustbernera@hotmail.com or telephone **07786963481**

CLOSING DATE FOR APPLICATIONS IS 5pm on 14th March 2022

BIGGER THAN US

I am delighted to introduce 'Bigger than us', my first Hebridean exhibition to be presented by Grinneabhat community gallery space, Bragar, this March through to April.

The collection features twenty original oil paintings inspired by the unstoppable, ever changing mood of the sea and her almighty power to move us.

The beautiful brute reality of nature on these untamed islands has already provided a lifetime's worth of painting inspiration for me in just a few short years and it feels so special to be able to share my interpretation of our coastal waters with the people who know this place the most.



look at the exhibition in your own time.

I hope to see you there.



Please accept this invitation to join me and the team at Grinneabhat for a private view and complimentary refreshments on Friday 4th March 2022 between 5pm - 7pm, where I will be giving a short talk about the work in the exhibition and be available to answer any of your questions. The show will run from 4th March until 30th April with the community cafe open from Tuesday to Saturday 11am -4pm, so even if you cannot make the party, there's plenty of time to pop along and take a

Rebecca Styles
Tobson



NA GEÒIDH

Fad grunn bhliadhnaichean a-nis tha sinn air a bhith a' cluinntinn mu na geòidh, gu h-àraidh na geòidh ghlasa air feadh nan Eilean. Ged a tha daoine a' feuchainn rì rian a chumail air àireamh nan gèadh, tha iad a' fàs nas lìonmhoire mar a thèid an ùine air adhart. Gun teagamh tha seo a' cur dragh mhòr air na coimhearsnachdan croitearachd oir tha na h-eòin gu math millteach.

Saoilidh mi gu bheil trioblaidean co-ionnan ann cuideachd le seòrsaichean eile de bheathaichean fiadhaich, iolairean-mara neo dobhar-choin mar eisimpleir.



Tha e fìor gur e plàighean a th' anns na geòidh ach a dh' aindeoin sin tha iad breàgha agus mòrail ag itealaich gu fuaimneach anns na speuran. Nuair a sgrìobh mi "gu fuaimneach", chuimhnich mi air sgeulachd a leugh sinn san sgoil mu na "Geòidh Capitoline". 'S e beathaichean coisrigte dhan bhan-dìà Ròmanach, Juno, a bh' annta, a bha a' fuireach ann an teampall air a' chnoc, Capitoline, san Ròimh.

Aon oidhche nuair a bha a' ghealach a' deàrrsadh gu soilleir, shreap saighdearan nàimhdeil suas na creagan gus na Ròmanaich a mharbhadh. Bha iadsan agus na coin nan cadal, mar sin cha chuala iad càil sam bith, ach bha na geòidh furachail agus thoisich iad air gloicail gun stad. Dhùisg na

Ròmanaich leis an fhuaim agus thug iad buaidh air an nàimhdean. Bha a' mhuinntir cho taingeil is dh' eigh iad gu h-aon-ghuthach: " 'S e ar geòidh am freiceadan as fhèarr!"

Gu pearsanta, chan eil mi glè dhèidheil air geòidh oir chuir iad dearg eagal orm nuair a bha mi nam nighean bheag. Bha mi a' cluich anns an achadh far an robh mo mhàthair agus a caraid a' glanadh nan taighean-chearc. Gu h-obann, nochd buidheann de gheòidh, bha iad a' tighinn dham ionnsaigh na b' fhaighe is na b' fhaighe, a' sìneadh a-mach nan amhaichean fada agus a' deanamh fuaim uabhasach. Sheas mi an sin gun ghluasad agus thoisich mi a' sgreuchail oir bha mi a' smaoinachadh gum biodh iad gam ithe.

Thàinig mo màthair na ruith gus faighinn a-mach dè bha a' tachairt is bha mise a' faireachdainn sàbhailte a-rithist.

Linne NicLeòid
Dun Innes



BERNERA BAKES... MERINGUE CAKE

INGREDIENTS:

Cake base

3oz Margarine
4oz Caster sugar
6oz Self raising flour
2 Egg yolks
2tbsp Milk
1tsp Vanilla essence

Topping

2 Large egg whites
2oz Coconut
4oz Caster sugar

METHOD:

1. Cream margarine and sugar then beat in egg yolks. Add the flour.
2. Spread mixture on the base of 11x7" tin.
3. Whisk the egg whites, adding sugar. Fold in the coconut.
4. Spread over the cake mixture.
5. Bake at 160°C for 30mins.
6. When cool, cut into squares.



Careen MacLennan
Kirkibost



RECORDING WILDLIFE SIGHTINGS IN THE OUTER HEBRIDES

In 1997, Alison Johnson and I were asked to produce a "Western Isles Discovery Book" for the Scottish Wildlife Trust. I mention this because it was the first time that it was brought home to me how different the distribution of some animals was from one island group to another.

Despite being a popular place for visiting naturalists, access to information on what had been recorded, and where, was difficult to find. Later, the work involved in creating a Biodiversity Action Plan for the Outer Hebrides made this abundantly clear.



Currag, the Outer Hebrides Natural History Society took up the challenge and with funding from LEADER, Comhairle nan Eilean and the RSPB, established Outer Hebrides Biological Recording, (OHBR). The primary objective was to collect and make freely available information on the plants, animals, and the whole suite of micro organisms that make up the natural environment of the islands. Volunteers have been adding to this database since 2012 and we now have a vast collection of carefully checked and collated records. OHBR is organised by a group of local naturalists and receives a small grant from Nature Scot.

Bird recording was fairly well established but records from some islands are still few and far between especially for the more common birds. When we receive records of birds they

are passed on to the county recorder for the Outer Hebrides. www.outerhebridesbirds.org.uk

The dinosaurs amongst us, myself included, were reluctant to embrace FaceBook but have to admit that it has been a huge success, especially in the recent covid affected years. It has increased interest throughout the islands and held us together when it was impossible to meet in the field. Learning from each other whilst searching different habitats is very enjoyable, but using social media we can still share our expertise, help with identification, and recommend where to find additional information on the internet. Many of us have enjoyed making a list of all the plants and animals that live around our homes. Recording wildlife is one way we can all help protect the biodiversity of the islands.

Biological recording is not difficult, and your observations of common species are as important as any number of reports about rare animals or plants. All we need to know is what you saw (the common name is fine if you don't know the scientific name), when, where (if you can't give a map reference, a postcode or location name is OK) and your name. All this and lots more is explained on the OHBR website www.ohbr.org.uk/recording-wildlife and you can always ask for help on the Facebook page. Signs of Spring are what we are all waiting for now, and it is also the name of our latest project. The aim is to collect first sightings of nine species: three birds, three insects and three flowers. All are well known and easily identified species associated with the arrival of spring in the Outer Hebrides.

If you'd like to take part in the Signs of Spring project it's really very easy. Firstly, choose a recording site. This should be somewhere you visit regularly, for example your garden. Make sure you check the site regularly, at least twice a week. Then simply record the first time you hear or see any of the following species at that site:

Flowers - Lesser Celandine; Lady's Smock (Cuckoo Flower); Yellow Flag Iris

Birds - Swallow; Wheatear; Corncrake

Insects - White-tailed Bumblebee; Green-veined White Butterfly; Large Red Damselfly

Then send us your records. This can be done through our website **www.ohchr.org.uk**, by email **admin@ohbr.org.uk**, or by post to **OHBR, 24b Ardivachar, South Uist, HS8 5RF.**

Please include your name and contact information, the species name, the location (ideally with a map reference), and the date it was spotted.

Bill Neill
OHBR



GREAT BERNERA COMMUNITY DEVELOPMENT TRUST



The GBCDT would like to introduce and warmly welcome Nat Higginbottom into his new role as Part Time Development Officer.

Nat and his wife Julia, originally from South Africa, moved from Birmingham to Kirkibost in 2019. They now run a croft and a small shop which sells home grown produce, as well as other locally sourced supplies, and Nat also undertakes remote working from home.

Nat is a highly skilled and creative craft editor with over 28 years of professional experience. His work has included programming, award winning broadcast television, video and film production, digital innovation, web design and social media management. He also has a drive and passion for helping to bring about positive change in communities through

community engagement projects, collaborative working and the sharing of skills and knowledge.

One of Nat's first roles as Development Officer will be designing and developing the Trust's digital capabilities. This will include working on a new website, improving community interaction through social media and creating archives of existing projects for the work of the Trust.

Nat's skill set, experience and creative thinking will be a great asset to the team, and we wish him all the best in this new role.

To contact Nat, phone, text or WhatsApp him on **07831 690547** or email **nat@croft22.co.uk**

Kirkibost Pontoon Development – Update



First with the lockdown and then the ongoing building work on the new bridge, the projected completion date of late Spring 2021 for the Kirkibost Marina project came and went. However, while the new bridge restrictions and lack of electricity supply have delayed things, parts of the project have been steadily moving forward. With project manager, John Porteous, at the helm and overseeing the construction works, the Kirkibost Pontoon development is progressing well.

The pontoons are now complete and it is hoped that by mid-March the process of appointing berths can begin. There will

be space for approximately 12/14 berths for local use and three to four outer berths (in deeper water) for visiting yachts. The pontoon power bollards (electricity supply) and water points however are still works in progress, but it is hoped that these will be ready by the end of April. The electrical supply to boats will be charged for separately.

Over the next few weeks, a management group will be formed to deal with the day to day running and booking of the pontoon and associated facilities. Once the group is set up, consultations involving the local community about proposed rates for the berths and expressions of interest can take place. It will be likely that rates will be charged monthly/six monthly. If you are interested in a berth, please contact Callum J Macaulay by emailing him at **dubhthob@gmail.com**. Callum is also dealing with all pontoon enquiries.

Due to the new bridge delays, the second stage of the Marina Hub project has also been delayed but as we write, local contractors are being contacted to start work on the new facilities building in March. This will house a pontoon management office, toilets, shower and laundry facilities. A separate waste disposal point will also be installed at the Kirkibost Pier area. It is estimated that this should take between three and four months to complete.



HE IS FAITHFUL

The island delicacy, sgadan saillte agus buntàta (salt herring & potatoes), is not for the faint hearted, but utterly delicious to those who eagerly desire it. And the 'earlier' the potato, the better. All washed down with plentiful cups of milk.

In Ireland over 176 years ago, the Irish Potato Famine (1846-1851) reduced the population of the west of Ireland by 30 percent. The prolonged suffering of our fellow island Celts, caused them to be broken in body and spirit.

The wealthy proprietor of Castle Caldwell, in County Fermanagh, was working on the recovery of his estate when he noticed that the outside walls of his tenant's cottages had a vibrant white finish. On enquiring, he found out that there was a clay deposit on his property of unusually exceptional quality. As a businessman he sought new ways to increase income, and provide jobs for those living on his estate. And so he built a pottery at the village of Belleek in 1857. The quality of the clay resulted in the creation of a very fine porcelain that possessed a translucent, glass-like finish. Becoming an instant hit as it was woven into traditional Irish designs.

Today, Belleek's delicate strength and its iridescent pearlized glaze is sought after worldwide. Out of tragedy, new hope was born.

Reminding us that at our times of greatest trial, God does not forsake his people, but reminds us that 'He is faithful'. Not allowing us to be tempted beyond what we are able, but with the temptation will also make the way of escape, that we may be able to endure it', **1 Cor 10:13**

Rev Hugh Maurice Stewart
Uig & Bernera



HISTORY QUIZ

1. Fastest steam train named for a bird
2. Queen Elizabeth I spy master
3. Norsemen of old commonly known as
4. Pirate Edward Teach better known as
5. Julius Caesar had what title on the ides of March
6. Battle of Stirling Bridge took place in what year
7. Hill on which Jesus was crucified
8. Howard Carter's aristocratic sponsor
9. Egyptian temple relocated in 1960s
10. It was built by pharaoh
11. 1824 saw a Great Fire in which Scottish city
12. Centre of the Ottoman Empire
13. Indian Chief at Battle of the Little Bighorn
14. Napoleons adversary at Waterloo
15. D-Day landings code name
16. Proprietor of Lewis at time of Bernera Riot
17. Birth place of legendary King Arthur
18. Alexander Graham Bell invented this
19. Nasa's first manned mission project called
20. British commander at Siege of Mafeking
21. He went on to found what organisation
22. Bay of Pigs invasion was in what country
23. Who was known as the Sun King
24. Shakespeare play collection published post death
25. State of Israel was created in
26. Callanish Stones built by which people
27. The Parthenon was dedicated to whom
28. Scottish earl went to N America before Columbus
29. Knights Templar thought to be forerunner of who
30. Vindolanda is a roman fort on which structure

Colin Halliday
Kirkibost

